

Priority Four

Parks, Recreation & Healthy Families

"Great cities are measured not only by their buildings and budgets, but by the opportunities they create for families to live healthy, active, and connected lives."

Why This Matters

Some of my greatest childhood memories were made in our local parks.

Growing up in Los Angeles, my brothers and I spent countless hours playing baseball, football, basketball, and simply enjoying the outdoors. Those parks gave us a safe place to play, build friendships, learn teamwork, and develop a lifelong appreciation for community.

Years later, as a father raising twin daughters, I experienced our parks from a different perspective.

My wife, Alex, and I often found ourselves leaving West Covina because many of the recreational opportunities available to boys simply were not available to girls within our own city. We drove to neighboring communities so our daughters could participate in athletic programs and activities that should have been available here at home.

That experience shaped my belief that every child deserves the opportunity to participate, regardless of gender, income, or neighborhood.

Parks are much more than green spaces.

They are where children discover their passions.

Where families spend time together.

Where seniors stay active.

Where neighbors become friends.

Where communities are built.

Investing in parks is investing in people.

As Your Councilmember, I Will Advocate For:

Beautiful, Safe & Well-Maintained Parks

- Continue investing in the maintenance and improvement of all sixteen city parks.
- Improve park safety through lighting, maintenance, and regular inspections.
- Modernize playground equipment when appropriate.
- Improve restroom cleanliness and accessibility.
- Ensure every neighborhood has access to clean, welcoming public spaces.

Recreation for Every Generation

- Expand recreation opportunities for children, teens, adults, and seniors.
- Increase after-school and summer programming.
- Promote activities that encourage healthy lifestyles.
- Support cultural, educational, and family-oriented community events.
- Continue exploring innovative recreation programs offered by successful California cities.

Expanding Opportunities for Girls & Young Women

One issue that has always been important to my family is ensuring girls have the same opportunities as boys.

Every child deserves the opportunity to participate in sports, recreation, leadership, and community programs.

I will work to:

- Expand recreational programming specifically designed for girls and young women.
- Increase opportunities for youth leadership development.
- Support partnerships that encourage girls to participate in athletics, science, technology, arts, and community service.
- Ensure future recreation planning considers the needs of all families.

Supporting Our Seniors

Our parks should serve every generation.

I will support efforts that:

- Expand senior recreation opportunities.
- Improve accessibility throughout our parks.
- Encourage walking clubs and outdoor wellness activities.
- Increase opportunities for lifelong learning and social engagement.
- Create spaces where seniors can remain active, connected, and healthy.

Community Events

"Strong communities are built when neighbors come together."

Community events bring people together. They create opportunities for families, neighbors, businesses, and community organizations to connect, celebrate, and build lasting relationships. They strengthen civic pride, encourage volunteerism, support local businesses, and contribute to the quality of life that makes West Covina a wonderful place to live. When thoughtfully planned and responsibly managed, community events help build a stronger, more connected community.

I support community events that are:

- Family-friendly and inclusive.
- Financially responsible and sustainable.
- Planned with transparency and accountability.
- Accessible to residents throughout our community.
- Designed to strengthen neighborhood connections and celebrate the diversity of West Covina.

As Your Councilmember, I Will Support:

- Family festivals.
- Outdoor concerts.
- Holiday celebrations.
- Farmers markets.
- Cultural events.
- Community fitness activities.
- Events that celebrate the diversity of our city.

Responsible Stewardship

Community events should always serve the public interest and reflect the City's financial priorities. Community events should never become an end in themselves. They should strengthen our community, reflect responsible stewardship of public resources, and always place the interests of residents above politics or personal recognition. Before

expanding programs or creating new events, we should ensure they are fiscally responsible, transparently managed, and provide clear value to the residents they are intended to serve.

Like every City program, community events should be evaluated based on their value to residents, their measurable community benefit, and their long-term financial sustainability.

City resources should always be used responsibly, and public events should bring our community together—not advance personal, political, or private interests. Every dollar invested in community events should be managed with the same accountability and transparency that residents expect from every other City program.

Strong communities are built when neighbors know one another, trust one another, and have opportunities to come together. My goal is to ensure that every community event reflects the values of fiscal responsibility, transparency, inclusiveness, and community pride while creating lasting memories for families throughout West Covina.

Healthy Families

"Healthy families are the foundation of a healthy community."

Strong cities begin with strong families.

While City government does not control healthcare policy, it can play an important role in improving community wellness, expanding partnerships, increasing awareness, and connecting residents with valuable resources.

Healthy communities are created when government works alongside hospitals, schools, nonprofit organizations, healthcare providers, businesses, and residents.

Our City should be a partner in helping families live healthier lives.

Women's Health

Women's health holds a special place in my heart because of the remarkable women who have shaped my life.

Through countless conversations with my wife, Alex, my twin daughters, family members, friends, colleagues, and women throughout our community, I have gained a much deeper appreciation for the healthcare challenges many women face.

I have listened as women described long waits to see specialists, difficulties accessing care, concerns about preventive screenings, and times when they felt their voices were not fully heard.

Those conversations have reinforced my belief that supporting women's health strengthens entire families.

Although many healthcare decisions occur outside the authority of City government, West Covina can still make a meaningful difference through education, partnerships, advocacy, and community engagement.

As Your Councilmember, I Will Advocate For:

Supporting Women's Health

- Partnering with local hospitals, healthcare providers, and nonprofit organizations.
- Supporting women's health education programs.
- Promoting preventive healthcare and early screenings.
- Expanding awareness of available community health resources.
- Supporting community wellness fairs and educational events.
- Encouraging programs that improve maternal health and family wellness.
- Ensuring women's perspectives are included whenever City policies impact health, recreation, safety, or quality of life.

Building Healthier Families

- Promote healthy living through parks and recreation.
- Encourage active lifestyles for children and adults.
- Expand community wellness programs.
- Support mental health awareness initiatives.
- Strengthen partnerships between schools, healthcare providers, and community organizations.
- Encourage preventative health education throughout our community.

Healthy women strengthen healthy families.

Healthy families strengthen West Covina.

Investing in the Next Generation

The investments we make in our parks, recreation programs, and families today will shape the community our children inherit tomorrow.

Every playground we improve...

Every recreation program we expand...

Every family we support...

Every opportunity we create...

Strengthens the future of West Covina.

Our goal should be simple:

Create a city where every child has the opportunity to succeed.

Every family feels connected.

Every senior feels valued.

And every resident is proud to call West Covina home.

My Commitment

I believe government should invest in the things that bring people together.

Parks.

Recreation.

Families.

Health.

Community.

These are not luxuries.

They are investments that improve quality of life, strengthen neighborhoods, reduce crime, encourage healthy living, and create lasting memories for generations to come.

As your Councilmember, I will work to ensure that every resident—regardless of age, neighborhood, or background—has access to safe parks, meaningful recreation opportunities, and programs that help families thrive.

Great communities aren't built by buildings alone. They are built by investing in people.

Looking Ahead

Strong parks and healthy families improve quality of life.

But long-term prosperity also depends on a strong local economy.

The next priority focuses on supporting our local businesses, attracting quality employers, revitalizing commercial corridors, and creating opportunities that allow West Covina to thrive for generations to come.

That begins with Priority Five: Economic Opportunity & Local Businesses.